

- Q6. "In practice, we find that myth, magic, and religion are a direct response to the vital needs, interests, and emotions of mankind. They deal with the fundamental problems of existence." How did Malinowski view the functions of myth, magic, and religion in addressing the fundamental needs and concerns of human societies? (20 marks)

Malinowski in Coral Gardens and their Magic said "Myth, Magic and Religion" lie on fact that HOPE cannot fail.

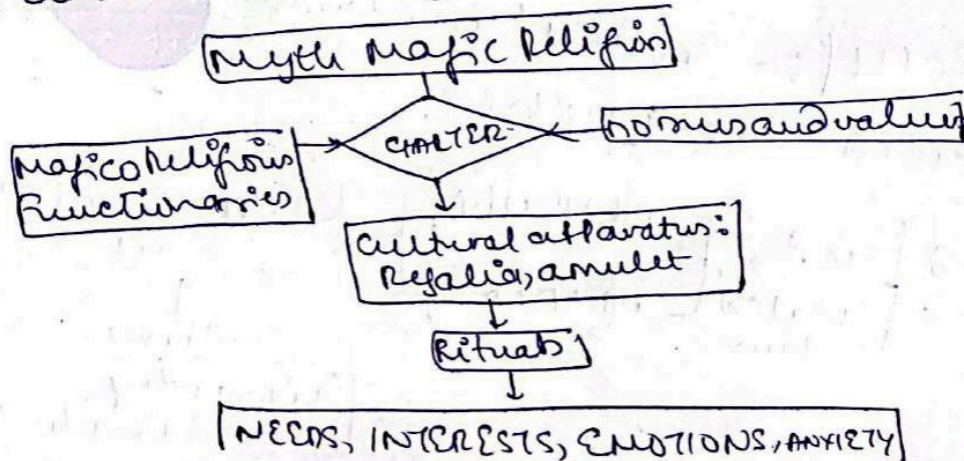
MALINOWSKI'S VIEW ON FUNCTION OF MYTH, MAGIC, RELIGION :-

Malinowski's functionalism is called "Bio cultural" or "psychological functionalism".

He said - on

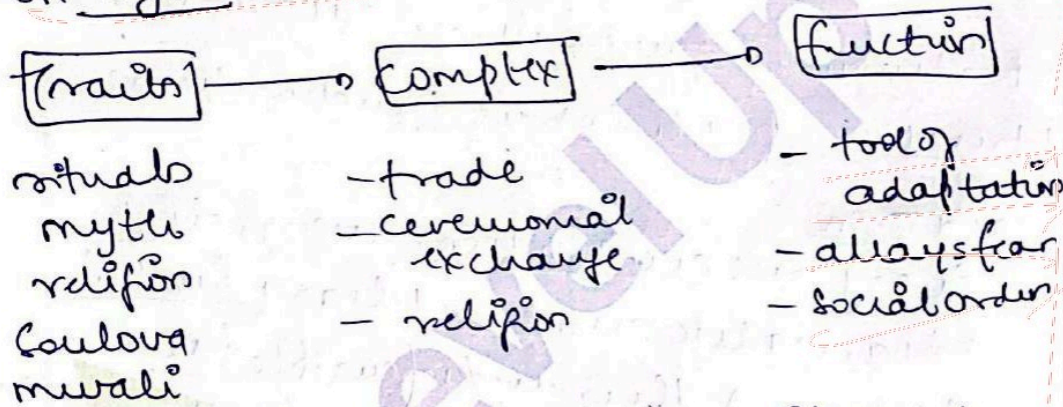
"Every civilisation, every belief, idea, value, material has a function, task and this indispensable fact interprets it to be entire functioning whole of culture" [THE SCIENTIFIC THEORY OF CULTURE]

i.e., magic, myth, religion satisfy needs of an individual. (THE THEORY OF NEEDS)



Case study of Kula Trade and associated rituals, myth:-

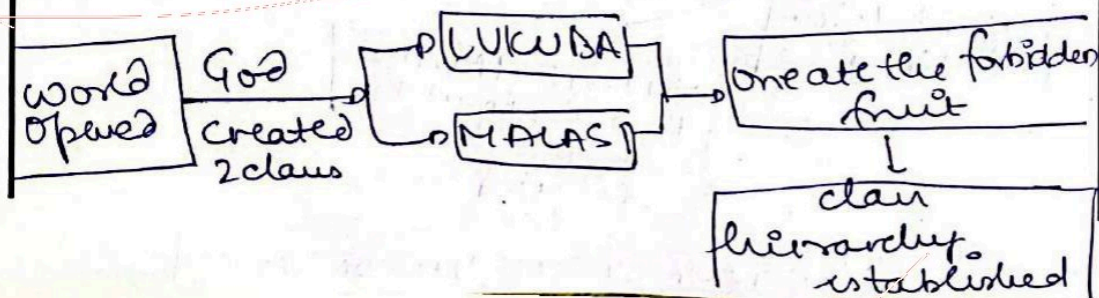
The Trobrianders take kula / cerebral exchange and believe that they do rituals for canoe and do expressions and magic. The INITIATIVE MAGIC is done for safe journey. The direction of trade is based on myth and is enforced by beliefs.



Thus in teparation of all these aids needs emotional relation. In difficult unpredictable times, the tribes fall back on them.

[MYTH] :- In Coral Gardens the magic

he cited the myth:-



Three functions of myth:-

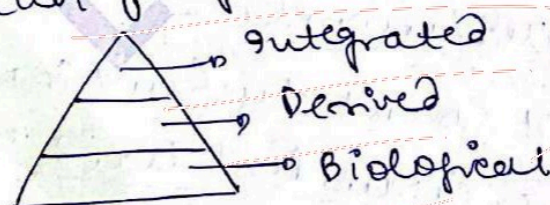
- ① Social order and hierarchy
- ② Territorial and dispute resolution
- ③ Identity of individual

Myth and MAGIC AND RELIGION:-

Malinowski said "when all technology fails, the tribes turn to magic and religion. They do not differentiate between the two and address vital desires of society."

THEORY OF NEEDS:-

Malinowski said that at 3 levels the culture fulfils needs:-



Primitive Vital Sequences:- These are basic needs of man:-

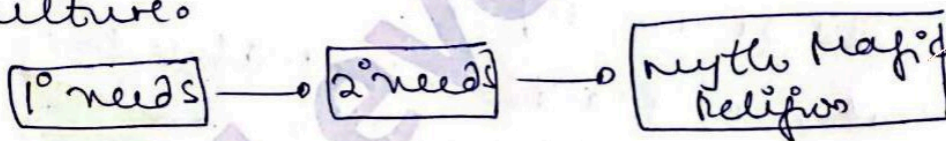
Metabolism	→ Commissariat
Movement	→ Activities
Growth	→ Training
Reproduction	→ Kinship
Hygiene	→ Health

Modily Comfort	→ Shelter
Safety	→ Protection

Integrate Superative 2° Needs:-
He said to fulfil 1° needs certain 2° needs are got:-

cultural apparatus	Economy
Sanction	socialisation
Power	authority
Human Behaviour	education

at the level after this, myth magic and religion fulfil the needs of a culture.



Criticisms of Malinowski:-

- ① Did not count dysfunctional role of culture. Evans Pritchard said that dances and rites in African tribes create conflict
- ② Used tautological, normative and ahistorical approach.

Current relevance: This theory can explain rise in religiosity in atheist China as JOB crisis and cost of living rises among youth.